

Daily Current Affairs Notes

Morning Session • Krati Ma'am • 4th & 5th September 2026 (Janmashtami Session)

1. SCO (Shanghai Cooperation Organisation) – Full Coverage

Background & Formation

Original name: Shanghai Five, formed in **1995**.

Founding members (5): China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan.

- Uzbekistan added – 2001
- India & Pakistan added – 2017
- Iran added – 2023-24
- Belarus added – 2025-26

Total current members: 10.

Headquarters: Beijing, China.

Anniversary: SCO is currently completing **25 years**.

Observer states: Afghanistan and Mongolia.

Latest Summit (26th Edition)

Host city: Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan (Bishkek is the capital of Kyrgyzstan).

Outcome document: "Bishkek Declaration."

Chaired by: President of Kyrgyzstan, Sadyr Japarov.

Theme of the summit: "25 Years of SCO."

Frequency: The summit is held every year.

Next host (2027): Pakistan has been given the chairmanship/hosting rights for the 2027 edition.

SCO Tourism & Cultural Capital (2026-27): Lahore has been announced as the SCO Tourism and Cultural Capital (India previously had Gujarat and Varanasi named as tourist capitals under SCO).

Proposed New SCO Development Bank

Russia has proposed forming a new **SCO Development Bank**, together with India and support from Kazakhstan. Originally the SCO framework was set up under China's leadership. Its related counter-terrorism body is called **RATS** (Regional Anti-Terrorist Structure), which works against terrorism.

Comparable existing banks:

- BRICS Bank → New Development Bank (NDB), HQ: Shanghai.
- China's bank → AIIB (Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank), HQ: Beijing.
- Proposed SCO Bank → Russia has suggested its headquarters be located in Russia (not yet finalised).

SCO Member & Observer List (for revision)

Members: China, Russia, Kazakhstan, Kyrgyzstan, Tajikistan, Uzbekistan, India, Pakistan, Iran, Belarus.

Observers: Afghanistan, Mongolia.

Match the Following – International Summits & Host Countries

Summit	Host Country / Location
G20 Summit	India (2023)
COP28	UAE
SCO Summit (26th edition)	Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan
BRICS Summit	Mid-September 2026 (upcoming)

Note: For "Match the Following" type questions on summits, focus on which country hosted which summit rather than memorising exact years.

2. Indus Waters Treaty – Permanent Court of Arbitration Ruling

Treaty signed: 1960, between India and Pakistan, brokered by the World Bank.

River Distribution under the Treaty

- **Western rivers** – Indus, Chenab, Jhelum: 80% water usage to Pakistan, 20% to India.
- **Eastern rivers** – Beas, Ravi, Sutlej: 80% water usage to India, 20% to Pakistan.

Background of Current Dispute

After the Pahalgam terror attack, India announced it would stop following the Indus Waters Treaty and would fully utilise water from rivers flowing through its territory. Pakistan approached the **Permanent Court of Arbitration (PCA)**, established in **1899**, headquartered at **The Hague, Netherlands**.

Court's Key Rulings (against India's position)

1. India should not reject the Indus Waters Treaty; it must continue following it.
2. The existing water-distribution formula must be followed without unilateral changes by India.
3. India's construction of the **Ratle Dam** on the Chenab river is impermissible, as it could restrict water flow to Pakistan.

India's response: India has rejected the ruling, stating that PCA decisions are not legally binding on it and it will continue construction and its own water-usage decisions.

About the Chenab River

Chenab is the largest tributary of the Indus river. It originates in Himachal Pradesh, formed by the confluence of two rivers – **Chandra** and **Bhaga**. The Chenab river is also known for a famous **arch bridge**, over which the **Vande Bharat** train recently ran for the first time.

3. Match the Following – International Organisations & Headquarters

Organisation	Headquarters
UN (United Nations)	New York, USA
WHO (World Health Organisation)	Geneva, Switzerland
UNESCO	Paris, France
WTO (World Trade Organisation)	Geneva, Switzerland
IMF (International Monetary Fund)	Washington D.C., USA

4. Defence & Security

Russia's Intercontinental Ballistic Missile Test

Missile name: RS-24 Yars.

Type: Intercontinental Ballistic Missile (ICBM) – any missile with range above 5000 km is classified as ICBM.

Range tested: 6,700 km (maximum capability up to 10,000 km).

Test site: Kura test range, Russia (near Kamchatka Peninsula, a highly volcanically active region).

Fuel type: Solid fuel.

Stages: Three-stage missile.

Other features: Nuclear-capable; can be launched from mobile platforms (road, sea, etc.).

India's comparable ICBMs: Agni-V and Agni-VI.

Japan's Missile Defence System – "Typhon"

System name: Typhon.

Developed by: USA; deployed by Japan against a perceived Russian threat (linked to Vladimir Putin's recent visit near the Kuril Islands, which Japan also claims).

Range: 320 km to 1,500 km.

Note: Do not confuse with THAAD, which was given to South Korea by the USA.

Khagantak-243 – Long Range Glide Bomb

Tested by: Indian Air Force (not DRDO).

Developed by: Bharat Electronics Limited (BEL) and Zen Technologies / GSR Dynamics.

Predecessor: Gaurav glide bomb (earlier variant).

Weight: Approximately 300 kg.

Range: 144 km to 180 km.

Release altitude: Up to 12 km.

Speed: Approximately 0.8 Mach.

Can be dropped by: Any aircraft, which identifies the target and releases the glide bomb.

Aero India 2027

Edition: 16th edition.

Date: 8th February 2027.

Venue: Yelahanka Air Force Station, Bengaluru.

Status: Asia's largest air show; registrations opened from 3rd September 2026.

Match the Following – Indian Missiles & Categories

Missile	Category
BrahMos	Cruise missile
Nag	Anti-tank guided missile
Agni series	Ballistic missile (long range)
Akash	Short-range surface-to-air missile
Prithvi	Short-range ballistic missile

5. Science, Technology & Agriculture

Green FaRZ Complex (Mohali, Punjab)

Inaugurated by: Dr. Jitendra Singh.

Location: Mohali, Punjab.

Developed by: National Agri-Food Biomanufacturing Institute (NABI).

"FaRZ" refers to a facility where artificial conditions (temperature, humidity, atmosphere) are created to conduct research and experiments. This facility will be used for research on **Genetically Modified (GM) crops** such as GM cotton and Bt brinjal, to improve production and control crop diseases in advance.

UPI 123Pay – Digital Payments for Keypad (Feature) Phones

Launched by: PhonePe (an Indian digital payments company founded in 2015; operates in 11 languages).

UPI 123Pay allows users of basic keypad/feature phones (without internet or smartphone) to make digital payments via a simple SMS/text message, requiring only a 2G SIM connection – no internet or smartphone needed.

Reach: Aimed at over 200 million feature phone users; companies like Nokia, Lava and Intel (feature phone makers) are part of this initiative.

6. Government Schemes & Campaigns

Swachhata Pakhwada 2026 (Cleanliness Fortnight)

Launched by: J.P. Nadda.

Duration: 1st to 15th September.

Nodal Ministry: Ministry of Chemicals and Fertilizers.

Conducted ahead of Swachh Bharat Abhiyan's anniversary (launched 2nd October 2014). This year's pakhwada also includes a focus on "digital cleanliness" (removing unnecessary files, cookies, viruses from computers/laptops) and a target of bringing plastic usage down to zero.

National Nutrition Week

Organised by: Ministry of Women and Child Development.

Duration: 1st to 7th September.

Focused on providing proper nutrition awareness for children in anganwadis and primary schools.

7. Sports

Tamil Nadu's Olympic City

Location: Chennai.

Announced by: Tamil Nadu CM M.K. Stalin (referred to as "Thalapathy" in the session).

This follows PM Modi's statement that India may host the Olympics in 2036. States like Assam (building an Olympic-style swimming pool/ National Centre of Excellence for Swimming) and Tamil Nadu (Olympic City in Chennai) are developing training infrastructure for India's youth to win more medals.

Olympics & Commonwealth Games Hosting Timeline

Event	Year	Host City/Country
Olympics	2024	Paris
Olympics	2028	Los Angeles
Olympics	2032	Brisbane, Australia
Olympics	2036 (proposed)	Ahmedabad, India (possibility)
Commonwealth Games	2030	Ahmedabad, India

Ahmedabad is being developed as the "Sports Capital of India," hence multiple sporting events are being hosted there.

World Archery Para Series 2026

Hosted by: India, sponsored by Hyundai.

City & Venue: Ahmedabad, Gujarat – at the Sabarmati Riverfront.

Dates: 5th to 9th September 2026 (India hosting for the first time).

Stages: Three stages in total – Stage 1 in Bangkok, Stage 2 in Chessia (China), Stage 3 in India (Ahmedabad).

Key athletes participating: Sheetal Devi, Harvinder Singh, Rakesh Kumar (all Paris Paralympics medallists).

World Archery Championship (separate event): First held in 1931; held every 2 years; 2025 edition held in China; next edition in 2027.

National Sports of Neighbouring Countries

- Archery – National sport of Bhutan.
- Kabaddi – National sport of Bangladesh.

8. Heritage & Culture

Gollagudi Temple – Monument of National Importance

State: Telangana.

Declared by: Archaeological Survey of India (ASI).

ASI Formed: 1861; comes under the Ministry of Culture; first Director-General was Alexander Cunningham; current Director-General: Y.S. Rawat. ASI Headquarters: Delhi.

Temple built: 12th century, by the Kakatiya dynasty, in Kakatiya architectural style.

Location: Near Ramappa Temple, Mulugu district, Telangana. (Ramappa Temple is already on the UNESCO World Heritage list at serial number 39.)

Dedicated to: Lord Shiva; the temple has three sanctum sanctorums (garbhagriha).

About Telangana

Formed on 2nd June 2014 as India's 29th state; capital – Hyderabad. Known festivals: Bonalu and Bathukamma.

9. Quick Revision – One-Liners

- **CEO of Ram Mandir Trust:** Jitendra Mishra.
- **Statue unveiled by Defence Minister in Lucknow:** Rani Avantibai Lodhi.
- **V-Dem Democracy Report:** India's democracy score compared to its lowest level, benchmarked against the year 1975.
- **Madhya Pradesh's "Mission Zero":** Jabalpur declared a fully waste-free city.
- **India's first imaging satellite launched into Geosynchronous orbit:** Launched by ISRO.
- **Swachh Sagar Surakshit Sagar:** 5th edition launched – a campaign to clean marine litter from coastal areas.
- **World Coconut Day:** Observed on 2nd September.
- **Legal Metrology – "One Nation One Time":** A single standard time to be followed across India.
- **New book on Donald Trump:** "Regime Change," authored by Maggie (Haberman) and Jonathan.
- **National Centre of Excellence for Swimming Pool:** Being built in Assam, to help India perform better in Olympic swimming events.
- **Match the Following – Ministers & Ministries:**

Minister	Ministry
Jitan Ram Manjhi	MSME
Jyotiraditya Scindia	Civil Aviation
Hardeep Singh Puri	Petroleum & Natural Gas
Kiren Rijiju	Parliamentary Affairs

Sarbananda Sonowal

Shipping, Ports & Waterways

10. All MCQs Asked in the Session (with Answers)

Q1. India recently participated in the SCO summit. Which new institution is being planned to be created through SCO?

Answer: The SCO Development Bank.

Q2. Match the following summits with their host countries: G20, BRICS, COP28, SCO Summit, ASEAN.

G20 → India (2023) | COP28 → UAE | SCO Summit → Kyrgyzstan (Bishkek) | BRICS → Upcoming, mid-September 2026

Answer: As matched above (host country identification, not exact year, is key).

Q3. Regarding the Indus Waters Treaty dispute, the Permanent Court of Arbitration ruled in favour of which country?

Answer: Pakistan (the Court ruled that India's rejection of the treaty and construction of the Ratle Dam was not valid; however, India has rejected this ruling as non-binding).

Q4. Match the following organisations with their headquarters: UN, WHO, UNESCO, WTO, IMF.

UN → New York | WHO → Geneva | UNESCO → Paris | WTO → Geneva | IMF → Washington D.C.

Answer: As matched above.

Q5. Which country recently tested an Intercontinental Ballistic Missile (ICBM) with a range of 6,700 km?

Answer: Russia (missile: RS-24 Yars, tested at the Kura test range).

Q6. The "Green FaRZ" complex has been inaugurated by Dr. Jitendra Singh. Where is it located?

Answer: Mohali, Punjab.

Q7. Match the following ministers with their ministries: Jitan Ram Manjhi, Jyotiraditya Scindia, Hardeep Singh Puri, Kiren Rijiju, Sarbananda Sonowal.

Jitan Ram Manjhi → MSME | Jyotiraditya Scindia → Civil Aviation | Hardeep Singh Puri → Petroleum & Natural Gas | Kiren Rijiju → Parliamentary Affairs | Sarbananda Sonowal → Shipping & Ports

Answer: As matched above.

Q8. The "Khagantak-243" glide bomb was recently tested by whom?

Answer: Indian Air Force (developed by Bharat Electronics Limited and GSR Dynamics).

Q9. Match the following missiles with their categories: Agni, Prithvi, Akash, Nag, BrahMos.

BrahMos → Cruise missile | Nag → Anti-tank guided missile | Agni → Ballistic missile | Akash → Surface-to-air missile | Prithvi → Short-range ballistic missile

Answer: As matched above.

Q10. Tamil Nadu is planning to establish an "Olympic City." In which city will it be built?

Answer: Chennai.

Q11. The Gollagudi Temple has been declared a "Monument of National Importance." In which Indian state is it located?

Answer: Telangana.

End of notes — Compiled from the morning current affairs session dated 4th/5th September 2026. Homework and topic for the 11:00 AM session (Folk Dance) were also announced separately in class.